Isaac Dalke

Curriculum Vitae – February 2026

Network Science Institute
Northeastern University
177 Huntington Avenue
Boston, MA 02115

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Subfields: Sociology of Law/Punishment, Political Sociology, Urban Sociology, Methods

Employment and Affiliations

Northeastern University Network Science Institute, August 2025 – Present
Data Justice Postdoctoral Fellow
Harvard University, August 2025 – Present
Institute for Policing, Incarceration, and Public Safety Postdoctoral Associate
Department of Sociology Fellow

Education

Ph.D. in Sociology, University of California, Berkeley –*2025*
Dissertation title: Making Community Count: Violence Prevention and the Delegated Penal State
Chris Muller (Harvard, co-chair), Loic Wacquant (co-chair)
M.A. in Sociology, University of California, Berkeley – *2020*
B.A. in Sociology with honors, University of Chicago – *2013*

Peer-Reviewed Publications

Greene, Joss and Isaac Dalke (equal authorship). 2025. "The Symbolic Weight of Penal Labor in Neoliberal Times." *Punishment & Society* online first. *https://doi.org/10.1177/14624745251320357*

Dalke, Isaac. 2024. "I Come Before You a Changed Man: 'Insight', Compliance, and Refurbishing Penal Practice in California." *Law & Social Inquiry* 49(2): 1138 – 1168. https://doi.org/10.1017/lsi.2023.20

- *ASA Sociology of Law Graduate Student Paper Award, Honorable Mention (2022)*

Dalke, Isaac and Joss Greene (equal authorship). 2024. "Prerequisites and Pathways: How social categorization helps administrators determine moral worth." *Theory and Society* 53 (1): 31-66. https://doi.org/10.1007/s11186-023-09523-6

Greene, Joss and Isaac Dalke (equal authorship). 2021. "'You're Still an Angry Man:' Parole Boards and Logics of Criminalized Masculinity." *Theoretical Criminology* 25(4): 639-662. https://doi.org/10.1177/1362480620910222

Other Writing

Dalke, Isaac. 2020. Review of *Courting the Community: Legitimacy and Punishment in a Community Court* by Christine Zozula (2019 from Temple University Press). *Contemporary Sociology* (49)6: 547-548. https://doi.org/10.1177/0094306120963121cc

Manuscripts in Progress

"Dissecting Resisting Arrest as a Cause of Police Violence," with Sandra Susan Smith and Jaqueline Lepe. *Under review at Law & Society Review*

"The Reluctant Bureaucrat: Decision-Making and Justification in Shifting Legal Contexts," with Brendon McConnell. *Under Review at the American Journal of Sociology*

"We've Got to Try Something Different: Alternatives to Policing and the Structural Emergence of Perpetual Experimentation." *Preparing for submission to the American Sociological Review*

Fellowships and Affiliations

Graduate Research Fellow, National Science Foundation (2019-2024)

Synar Graduate Student Fellow, Institute of Governmental Studies, UC-Berkeley (2023)

Sociology Equity, Inclusion, and Diversity Curriculum Fellow, UC-Berkeley (2022-2023)

Affiliated Graduate Student, Institute for the Study of Societal Issues (2019-present)

Presentations

"Making the Delegated Penal State: Violence Prevention in California, 1990-2005."
Carceral Political Economy Conference at The New School, March 21, 2025

"Making Community Count: Community-Based Violence Intervention and Governing through Nonprofits"
Law and Society Association Annual Conference, June 8, 2024
UC-Berkeley Institute for Governmental Studies, February 24, 2023

"On Neoliberalism and Nonprofits: A Computational Approach to Cultural Ideology"
American Sociological Association Annual Meeting, August 12, 2024
Text as Data Association Annual Meeting, November 9, 2023 (poster)
Georgetown University Interdisciplinary Text Analysis Research Group, May 11, 2022

"Prerequisites and Pathways: How Administrative Classification Matters for Moral Evaluation"
Law and Society Association Annual Conference, July 14, 2022

"I come before you a changed man: Historical Changes in the Vocabulary of Parole Release Decisions"
UC-Berkeley Computational Social Science Forum, September 21, 2021
Virtual Workshop on Contemporary Parole Research, April 22, 2021
Law and Society Association Annual Conference, May 30, 2020
Text Analysis Across Domains (TextXD) Conference, December 4, 2019
UC-Berkeley Computational Text Analysis Working Group, October 17, 2019

Research Positions

Graduate Student Researcher, Professor Armando Lara-Millan (2023-2025)

Graduate Student Researcher, UC-Berkeley Criminal Law & Justice Center (2024)

Graduate Student Researcher, Professor Sandra Smith (2018-2021)

Participant, Bay Area Summer Institute in Computational Social Science (Bay-SICSS) (2020)

Teaching

Social Inequality in America – Reader, Spring 2025 (Instructor: Joanna Reed)
Sociology of Poverty – Reader, Fall 2024 (Instructor: Martin Sanchez-Jankowski)
Sociology of Health and Medicine – Reader, Spring 2022 (Instructor: Caitlin Daniel)
Contemporary Sociological Theory – GSI, Fall 2021 (Instructor: Fatmir Haskaj)
Classical Sociological Theory – GSI, Fall 2018 (Instructor: Marion Fourcade)

Service

Public
California Violence Intervention and Prevention (CalVIP) Program Grant Application Reviewer (2025-26)
California Violence Intervention and Prevention Coalition Steering Committee Member (2023-2025)

Professional
Political Economy of Late Mass Incarceration Conference Program Committee Member (2026)
ASA Sociology of Law Student Paper Award Committee Member (2026)

UC-Berkeley
UC-Berkeley Underground Scholars Initiative Tutor (2022-2025)
UC-Berkeley Social Science Research Pathways Mentor (2022-2025)
UC-Berkeley Undergraduate Honors Thesis Mentor (2017-2024)
UC-Berkeley Sociology Department Graduate Student Lounge Redesign Committee (2023)
UC-Berkeley Sociology Equity, Inclusion, and Diversity Initiative Curriculum Fellow (2022-2023)
Text Across Domains Computational Text Analysis Conference Planning Committee (2022)
UC-Berkeley Sociology Anti-Racist Working Group Member (2020-2021)
UC-Berkeley Gender/Sexuality Workshop Coordinator (2019-2020)
UC-Berkeley Undergraduate-to-Graduate Pipeline Project Mentor (2018-2019)
UC-Berkeley Graduate Student Social Committee (2018-2019)

Ad Hoc Reviewer
Social Forces, Punishment & Society